

Grade 3 Ontario Curriculum Financial Literacy

Plan Your Party — Grade 3 Budgeting

Unit Overview: Plan Your Party — Grade 3 Budgeting

Grade: Grade 3 | **Strand:** Financial Literacy

Target Expectations: F1.1

Learning Goal: Children will estimate and calculate change for cash transactions in whole-dollar amounts and amounts under \$1.

Lesson	Lesson Title	Learning Goal
Day 1	Estimate the Change	I can estimate change for whole-dollar transactions.
Day 2	Calculate Exact Change	I can calculate exact change for whole-dollar transactions.
Day 3	Cents Change	I can calculate change in cents.
Day 4	Mixed Amounts	I can calculate change for mixed transactions.
Day 5	The Big Party Capstone	I can plan a budget and calculate change.

Lesson 1: Estimate the Change

Goal: ESTIMATE first! Round prices to nearest dollar, then subtract from money paid.

Expectation: F1.1

Learning Goal: "I can estimate change for whole-dollar transactions."

Materials: M1_money_set, M2_pricetag_set, M3_estimate_chart, M7_money_chart

1. Minds On (12 mins): Pat's Quick Change Estimate

Pat the Pup: Friends, when you BUY something, you might get CHANGE. Estimate first — round and subtract! Pat opens: 'PAID FIRST?' Class: 'PAID FIRST!'

Bring children to the carpet. Pat the Party Planner Pup puppet (felt pup with party hat). 'Money friends — Grade 2, you made COMBOS. Grade 3, we go further: when you PAY, you might get CHANGE BACK!'

2. Action (25 mins): Estimate 4 Transactions

- Hand out Money + Price Cards.
- Round prices first, then subtract.
- Stretch: predict if pair has enough money.
- Help with subtraction (count up if needed).
- Circulate to record diagnostic.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: Two pairs share their estimate strategies.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Pat's Estimate Brag

Discuss:

- What's CHANGE?
- What's ESTIMATE?
- How ROUND \$2.95?
- Item \$7, pay \$10 — change?
- Pat's preview: tomorrow Bea shows EXACT change (Lesson 2 — F1.1).

Exit: Pat's refrain — 'Pat asks: PAID FIRST? Children: PAID FIRST!' (3x).

Lesson 2: Calculate Exact Change

Goal: EXACT change = MONEY PAID minus PRICE. Use careful subtraction.

Expectation: F1.1

Learning Goal: "I can calculate exact change for whole-dollar transactions."

Materials: M1_money_set, M2_pricetag_set, M4_subtract_chart, M7_money_chart

1. Minds On (12 mins): Bea's Exact Calculator

Budget Bea: Friends — yesterday we ESTIMATED. Today we CALCULATE EXACT change! Bea opens: 'LINE UP, BORROW, SUBTRACT — that's EXACT!'

Bring children to the carpet. Bea the Bear puppet (small bear with calculator). 'Money friends — yesterday Pat showed us ESTIMATE. Today: EXACT calculation!'

2. Action (25 mins): Calculate 4 Exact Changes

- Hand out Money + Price Cards + Calculator.
- Write each subtraction step.
- Stretch: check each by addition.
- Help with borrowing in subtraction.
- Circulate to record formative.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: 'Show me YOUR way' beat — pairs solve \$20 - \$13 by any strategy (count up from 13, take 7 from 20, regroup).

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Bea's Exact Brag

Discuss:

- What's CALCULATE?
- What's SUBTRACT?
- How check change with ADDITION?
- \$20 - \$13 = ?

Exit: Bea's exact change refrain — 'Bea says: LINE UP, BORROW, SUBTRACT — that's EXACT!' (3x).

Lesson 3: Cents Change

Goal: AMOUNTS UNDER \$1 use CENTS (¢). Change is also in CENTS.

Expectation: F1.1

Learning Goal: "I can calculate change in cents."

Materials: M1_money_set, M2_pricetag_set, M4_subtract_chart, M7_money_chart

1. Minds On (12 mins): Pat's Cents Snack

Pat: Cookie costs 75¢. Pay \$1. CHANGE in cents — let's calculate! Pat opens: 'CENTS with cents, BUCKS with bucks!' Yesterday's bills + today's cents.

Bring children to the carpet. Pat puppet. 'Money friends — last 2 days, whole dollars. Today: CENTS!'

2. Action (25 mins): Calculate 4 Cents Changes

- Hand out Money + Price Cards.
- Count the change in coins.
- Stretch: find 2 coin combos for one change.
- Help with subtraction borrowing in cents.
- Circulate to record formative.
- STRATEGY COMPARE 'Two ways': After the first transaction, each pair finds TWO different coin decompositions for the same change.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Pat's Cents Brag

Discuss:

- What's a CENT?
- $100¢ = ?$
- Cookie 75¢, pay \$1.
- How count 25¢?

Exit: Pat's cents refrain — 'Pat says: CENTS with cents, BUCKS with bucks!' (3x).

Lesson 4: Mixed Amounts

Goal: MIXED amounts: \$1.50, \$3.25. Calculate change carefully.

Expectation: F1.1

Learning Goal: "I can calculate change for mixed transactions."

Materials: M1_money_set, M2_pricetag_set, M4_subtract_chart, M7_money_chart

1. Minds On (12 mins): Bea's Mixed Math

Bea: TODAY: \$1.50, \$3.25, \$4.75. Mixed amounts! Calculate change carefully.

Bring children to the carpet. Bea puppet with calculator. 'Money friends — last time CENTS only. Today MIXED: dollars AND cents!'

2. Action (25 mins): Calculate 4 Mixed Changes

- Hand out Money + Price Cards.
- Count change in coins + bills.
- Stretch: find 2 ways to give same change.
- Help with borrowing across \$ and ¢.
- Circulate to record formative.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Bea's Mixed Brag

Discuss:

- What's $\$1.50 + \1.50 ?
- $\$5 - \$3.25 = ?$
- How borrow from \$ to ¢?
- Item \$4.75, pay \$5 — change?

Exit: Each child shares ONE: 'Item \$____, change \$____.'

Lesson 5: The Big Party Capstone

Goal: Plan a PARTY: pick items, total cost, pay, calculate change!

Expectation: F1.1

Learning Goal: "I can plan a budget and calculate change."

Materials: M1_money_set, M2_pricetag_set, M3_estimate_chart, M4_subtract_chart

1. Minds On (12 mins): Pat + Bea's Party Plan

Pat + Bea: Today plan a PARTY with \$20! Pick items, total, pay, calculate change! Pat + Bea open: 'Estimate, EXACT, CENTS, MIXED — that's BUDGETING!'

Money friends — today is our CAPSTONE. On Day 1 we ESTIMATED with Pat. On Day 2 Bea showed EXACT change. Day 3 we did CENTS. Day 4 we mixed them. Today we put it all together to plan a party!

2. Action (25 mins): The Big Party

- Hand out templates.
- Stations 1-4: pick, total, pay, change.
- Stretch: write a 'planner's brag' — sentence per station.
- Help at Station 4 with subtraction.
- Circulate to record summative evidence.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: Two pairs share their party plans for the same budget.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Party Planner Brag

Discuss:

- What's a BUDGET?
- What's TOTAL?
- How calculate CHANGE?
- Did your total stay under \$20?

Exit: Capstone refrain — Pat + Bea call: 'Estimate, EXACT, CENTS, MIXED — that's BUDGETING!' (3x).

Name: _____

Date: _____

Pat's Quick Change

Learning Goal: I can estimate change for whole-dollar transactions.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Round 4 prices to the nearest dollar.
2. For 4 transactions, estimate the change.
3. Item \$4.50, pay \$5.

Round It

Round to the nearest amount.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Bea's Change Calculator

Learning Goal: I can calculate exact change for whole-dollar transactions.

Instructions for the Student:

1. For 4 transactions, calculate exact change with subtraction.
2. Check each by adding price + change.
3. Item \$48, pay \$50.

Check Change

Check the change.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Cents Change Practice

Learning Goal: I can calculate change in cents.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Calculate change for 4 cents transactions.
2. For 2 changes, draw the coins.
3. Cookie 35¢, pay 50¢.

Sort Coins

Sort coin groups.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Mixed Money Math

Learning Goal: I can calculate change for mixed transactions.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Calculate change for 4 mixed transactions.
2. For 2 changes, show the coin + bill mix.
3. Item \$7.25, pay \$10.

One Way

One way to pay.

Name: _____

Date: _____

The Big Party Plan

Learning Goal: I can plan a budget and calculate change.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Pick 4 items from a list of 8.
2. Pay \$20.
3. If your total is over \$20, swap an item to stay under \$20.

Swap

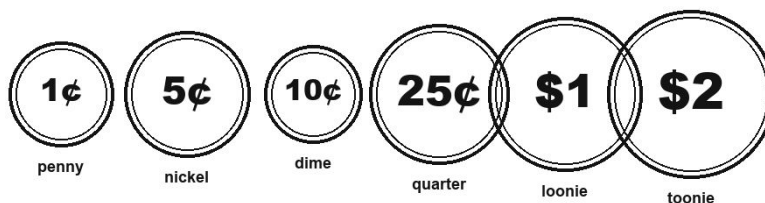
Swap to fit budget.

Mixed Money Cards

(M1_money_set)

30 paper cards (coins + bills) for transaction practice.

Canadian Coins



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 30 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

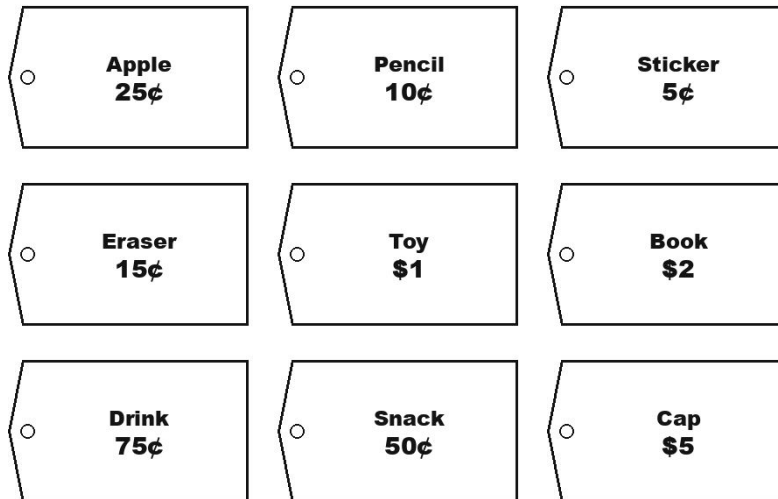
Prep: ~30 min

Item Price Cards

(M2_pricetag_set)

20 cards with party items and prices.

Price Tags



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 20 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~25 min

Estimate Strategy Chart

(M3_estimate_chart)

Anchor chart showing rounding to nearest dollar.

Amount Cards

\$ 5	\$ 10	\$ 25	\$ 50
\$ 100	\$ 200	\$ 500	\$ 1000

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall before Lesson 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart

Lessons: 1, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Subtract for Change Chart

(M4_subtract_chart)

Anchor chart showing change calculation.

Amount Cards

\$1 - 25¢	\$2 - 50¢	\$5 - \$1
\$10 - \$5	\$20 - \$11	\$50 - \$25

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape next to estimate chart before Lesson 2.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart

Lessons: 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Party Budget Template

(M5_budget_template)

Letter-size template with item rows and total.

Budget Worksheet

Item	Cost	Subtotal
TOTAL		

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 12 templates.

2. Laminate.

3. Distribute one per pair.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10-12 templates

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~15 min

Big Party Template

(M6_capstone_template)

Letter-size capstone template.

Big Party Template	
1	Pick _____
2	Total _____
3	Pay _____
4	Change _____

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: no

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 25 templates.

2. Stack near teacher table.

3. No lamination.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 25 templates

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~5 min

G3 Money Vocabulary Chart

(M7_money_chart)

Anchor chart with G3 money vocabulary.

G3 Money Vocabulary Chart	
Change	Transaction
• Estimate • Calculate • Round	• Budget • Subtract • Total

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall before Lesson 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Paper Calculator Cards

(M8_calculator_set)

12 paper calculator cards for change calculation.

Calculation Strip

$+$	$+$	$+$	$+$	$+$

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 12 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~20 min

Party Item Cards

(M9_party_cards)

16 party-themed item cards with prices.

Budget Worksheet

Item	Cost	Subtotal
TOTAL		

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 16 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

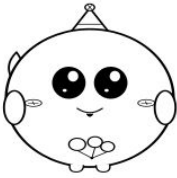
Lessons: 5

Prep: ~20 min

Plan Your Party Poster

(M10_unit_poster)

Unit anchor poster of Pat and Bea.

Plan Your Party Poster		
 Pat the Party Planner Pup	 Budget Bea the Bear	 Budget
 Balloons	 Cookies	 Money

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy on letter or 11x17.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall on Day 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 poster

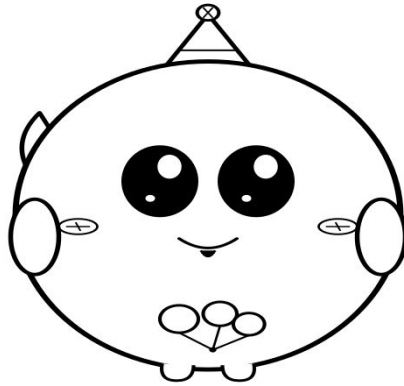
Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Pat Puppet

(char_pat_puppet)

Paper puppet of Pat the Party Planner Pup for teacher use in all 5 lessons.



Pat the Party Planner Pup

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Cut around silhouette and tab.

3. Laminate.

4. Glue popsicle stick.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet

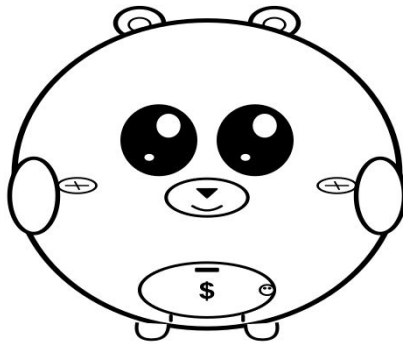
Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Budget Bea Puppet

(char_budget_puppet)

Paper puppet of Budget Bea the Bear for teacher use in Lessons 2-5.



Budget Bea the Bear

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Cut around silhouette and tab.

3. Laminate.

4. Glue popsicle stick.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet

Lessons: 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Name: _____

Date: _____

Summative Assessment Rubric

Expectation	Level 1 (Beginning)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 3 (Achieving)	Level 4 (Exceeding)
F1.1 estimate and calculate the change required for various simple cash transactions involving whole-dollar amounts and amounts of less than one dollar	Cannot subtract for change.	Calculates change with prompts.	Independently estimates and calculates change for whole-dollar and cents transactions.	Plans a budget within a limit and calculates change.

Junior Party Planner Certificate (G3)

This certificate is proudly presented to:

For successfully completing the 5-Day G3 Plan Your Party unit and demonstrating the skills of a G3 Junior Party Planner. Pat the Party Planner Pup congratulates the student.

By completing this unit, this student has demonstrated:

- Estimating change for transactions
- Calculating exact change with subtraction
- Working with cents amounts
- Planning a budget within a limit

Marketplace Listing

A 5-day Grade 3 unit on cash transactions and change framed around Pat the Party Planner Pup and Budget Bea the Bear.

Price: \$8.99 CAD

Pages: ~42

Classroom time: 250 min

Teacher prep: ~180 min

Top tags: Grade 3, math, money, change, transactions, budget, estimate, Ontario curriculum

What's included:

- Unit blueprint (1 file)
- 5 lesson plans (5 files)
- 5 worksheets (5 files)
- Manipulatives plan (1 file)
- Formative + reflection (1 file)
- Assessment suite (1 file)